


ICT CLUSTER VARNA

BSMEPA
BULGARIAN SMALL AND MEDIUM ENTERPRISES PROMOTION AGENCY

ВАРНА

BRAIN++
AI FACTORY

ARC FUND

# Cvetan Rusimov



**26 years**
in executive roles

## CEO at Imperia Online

19 years at the company, Joined as employee #8.
Board Member of CreaTech Bulgaria

**2 exits and 2 new startups**
Both startups now are multi-million businesses

**BD in Applied Mathematics, MD in Economics**
20+ non-sponsored lectures worldwide

**Jury:** Reboot, Nordic Games, PG Connects and IMGA China
**Mentor:** Game Founders, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

# Gaming in 2025

**$82 B**

Mobile in-app purchase revenue

**+1.4%**

vs 2024

**50 B**

Mobile game downloads

**−7.0%**

vs 2024

**$11.7 B**

Steam premium revenue

**+13.0%**

vs 2024

Source: Sensor Tower, State of Gaming 2026, p. 3. 2025 estimates. Mobile: iOS + Google Play. Revenue excludes mobile ads and third-party purchases. Steam: premium purchases.

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# The discovery problem

**≈ 225,000**

**game releases in 2025**

*iOS + Google Play + Steam*

**≈ 617**

**every day**

**During this 15-minute talk: roughly 6 more games.**

**AI can increase supply. Players still have 24 hours.**

# Console: fewer releases, more gates

Annual game releases




* Few mobile first studios already announced they'll expands to console in 2027.

Certification adds a gate. It cannot guarantee demand.

# Established IP have a head start

**8 of 8**

top PC/console games in ’25 & ‘26 by active users were established titles

***Fortnite, Counter-Strike 2, Minecraft, GTA V Legacy, Call of Duty, Roblox, PUBG and Rocket League***

## GTA VI

The release is on 19th November.

The entertainment world “will stop”.

# Product creation with AI

## AI can produce:

DEV: *Everything!*

**QA: Almost everything..**

ART*: Everything!*

Marketing & Video: *Everything!*

Storytelling & Copyright: *Everything!*

BI & Data: *Everything!*

**Game Design:**

**General ideas & deconstruction - but can’t build a hit!**

## People still decide:

Which problem is worth solving.

Which idea/version deserves release.

Whether it works for our customers.

**What to change to look like non-AI..**

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# If AI does all the junior tasks…

Where do the next senior people learn?

**Some tasks disappear.**

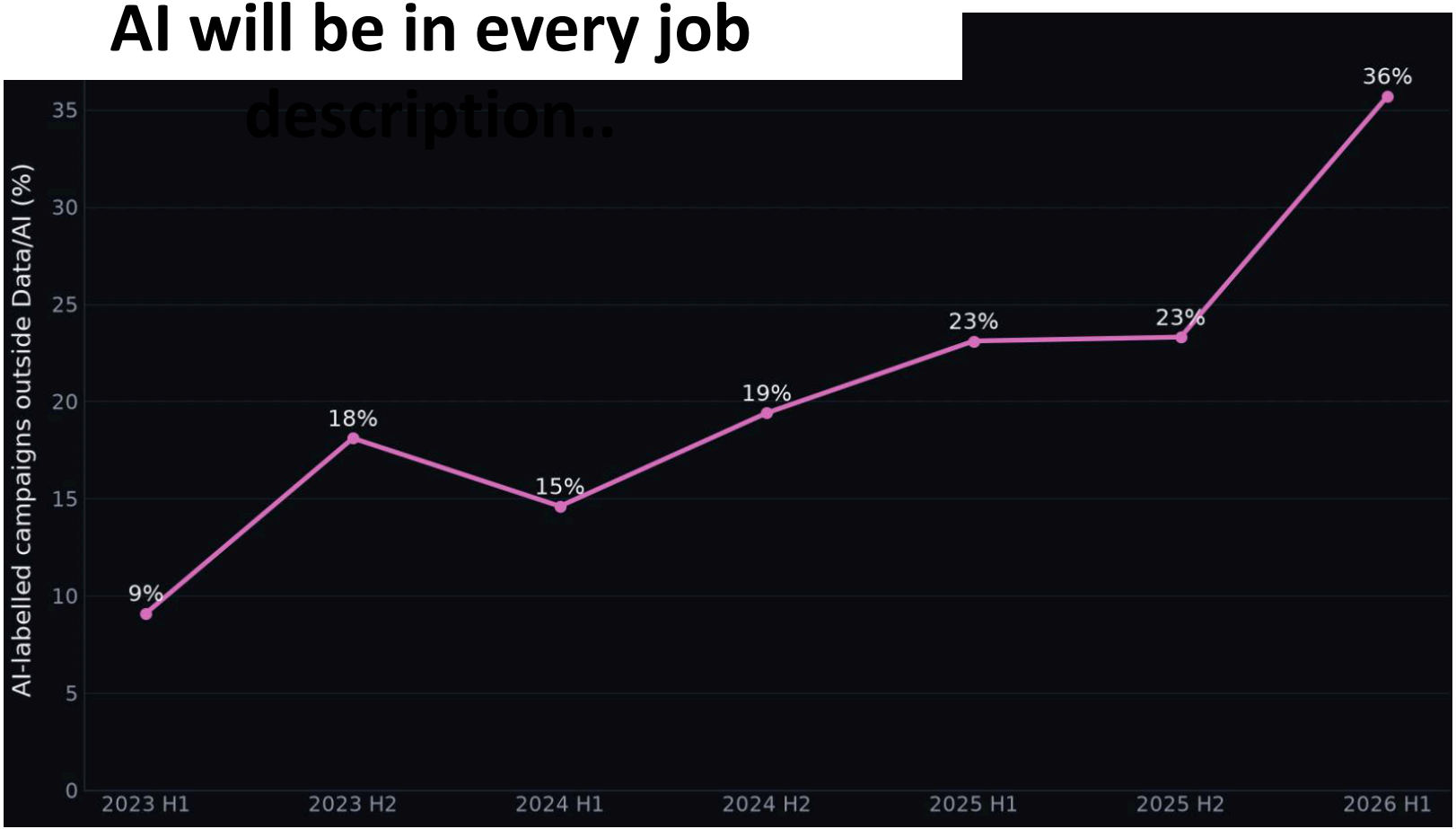
**Some roles change.**

**Some first jobs may never open.**




**Mastering all the AI tools available**

# AI will be in every job description..



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# AI will build it, but who will want it?

No one? Someone?

Everyone?

## Cons:

SaaS is dead.

Price of software will be zero.

Anyone can do it by themself.

We'll pay for tokens, not software

## Pros:

Software can finally help small business.

The cost of trying an idea approaches zero.

More people can become creators.

We'll pay for problems solved.


Thank
You!